

Come, go, bring, and take

Teaching guide

Describe movement from a clear point of view.

Understand the distinction

Come often describes movement toward the speaker, listener, or an agreed meeting place. Go commonly describes movement away or toward another place. Bring and take describe similar movement with a person or thing.

The viewpoint can be a future location. On the phone, I am coming to your office treats the listener as the destination. Bring your notes to our meeting uses the shared meeting as the reference point. Context can make more than one choice natural.

Compare the patterns

TOWARD US

Can you come to my desk?

The speaker is the destination.

ANOTHER PLACE

I need to go to the bank.

The bank is another destination.

WITH SOMETHING

Please bring your notes to our meeting.

The notes move toward the shared meeting.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. You are at home inviting a friend. Complete: Please ___ over.

A. take

B. go

C. come

2. You are leaving home for class. Complete: I must ___ my book with me.

A. take

B. taken

C. taking

3. Can come refer to the listener's location?

A. Yes: I am coming to your office.

B. Yes. Come always means movement away from both people.

C. No. Come can only mean movement to the speaker.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. You are inviting someone to your house and asking them to carry a drink there. Which wording fits?

- A. Come to my house for lunch. Please bringing a drink.
- B. Come to my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.
- C. Come my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. come

The friend moves toward you.

A: Take normally needs something or someone being moved; it does not fit come over.

B: The speaker is inviting the friend toward the speaker's home, so come fits.

2. A. take

You carry the book away from your current location.

B: Must takes the base verb take, not the past participle taken.

C: Must takes a base verb, so use take rather than taking.

3. A. Yes: I am coming to your office.

The viewpoint can be the listener or a shared destination.

B: Come normally uses the speaker's, listener's, or an agreed destination as its viewpoint.

C: Come can also refer to movement toward the listener.

4. B. Come to my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.

Come and bring use the host's destination as the viewpoint.

A: After please, use the base verb bring.

C: Come needs to before my house.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-11.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

You are inviting someone to your house and asking them to carry a drink there. Which wording fits?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.